

# Supporting Information for: Quantum-Coherent Spectral Engineering: Non-Markovian Dynamics in Photosynthetic Energy Transfer under Engineered Photon Baths

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# 1 PT-HOPS/SBD Formalism Details

## 1.1 Hierarchy Equations

The Process Tensor Hierarchy of Pure States (PT-HOPS) method extends the standard HOPS formalism by incorporating a process tensor that efficiently captures non-Markovian environmental memory. The hierarchy of pure states  $|\psi^{(\vec{n})}(t)\rangle$  evolves according to:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}|\psi^{(\vec{n})}(t)\rangle = \left(-i\mathbf{H}_S - \sum_j n_j \nu_j\right) |\psi^{(\vec{n})}(t)\rangle - i \sum_j \sqrt{(n_j + 1)d_j} L_j |\psi^{(\vec{n}+\vec{e}_j)}(t)\rangle - i \sum_j \sqrt{n_j/d_j} L_j^\dagger |\psi^{(\vec{n}-\vec{e}_j)}(t)\rangle, \quad (1)$$

where:

- $\vec{n} = (n_1, n_2, \dots, n_K)$  is the multi-index for hierarchy level
- $\nu_j$  are the bath correlation frequencies from Padé decomposition
- $d_j$  are the decomposition coefficients
- $L_j$  are the system coupling operators
- $\vec{e}_j$  is the unit vector in direction  $j$

## 1.2 Bath Correlation Function Decomposition

The bath correlation function is decomposed using Padé spectral decomposition:

$$C(t) = \sum_{k=0}^K d_k e^{-\nu_k t}, \quad (2)$$

where  $K$  is the number of Matsubara terms. For the Drude–Lorentz spectral density:

$$J_{\text{DL}}(\omega) = \frac{2\lambda\gamma\omega}{\omega^2 + \gamma^2}, \quad (3)$$

the correlation function at temperature  $T$  is:

$$C(t) = \frac{\lambda\gamma}{\beta} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-\nu_k t}}{\nu_k - \gamma} + \frac{\lambda\gamma}{2} \left[ \coth\left(\frac{\beta\gamma}{2}\right) - i \right] e^{-\gamma t}, \quad (4)$$

with Matsubara frequencies  $\nu_k = 2\pi k/\beta$  and  $\beta = 1/(k_B T)$ .

## 1.3 Spectrally Bundled Dissipators

The SBD approach groups environmental modes by spectral frequency, reducing the hierarchy dimension. For  $M$  spectral bundles:

$$J_{\text{bath}}(\omega) \approx \sum_{m=1}^M J_m(\omega), \quad (5)$$

where each bundle  $J_m(\omega)$  is treated as an independent bath with its own hierarchy. This enables scalable simulations of complex multisite systems.

Table 1: **PT-HOPS/SBD Simulation Parameters**

| Parameter                | Value           |
|--------------------------|-----------------|
| Hierarchy depth ( $L$ )  | 6               |
| Matsubara terms ( $K$ )  | 3               |
| Time step ( $\Delta t$ ) | 0.1 fs          |
| Total simulation time    | 1 000 fs        |
| Disorder realizations    | 100             |
| Precision                | Double (64-bit) |

## 1.4 Numerical Parameters

# 2 FMO Hamiltonian Parameters

## 2.1 Site Energies

The site energies  $\varepsilon_n$  for the seven bacteriochlorophyll-*a* molecules in FMO (from Ref. [1]):

Table 2: **FMO Site Energies ( $\text{cm}^{-1}$ )**

| $\varepsilon_1$ | $\varepsilon_2$ | $\varepsilon_3$ | $\varepsilon_4$ | $\varepsilon_5$ | $\varepsilon_6$ | $\varepsilon_7$ |
|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| 12400           | 12550           | 12250           | 12350           | 12450           | 12600           | 12500           |

## 2.2 Electronic Couplings

The electronic coupling matrix  $J_{nm}$  (in  $\text{cm}^{-1}$ ):

$$\mathbf{J} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -87.7 & 5.5 & -5.9 & 6.7 & -13.7 & -9.9 \\ -87.7 & 0 & 30.8 & 8.2 & 0.7 & -11.9 & 4.3 \\ 5.5 & 30.8 & 0 & -53.5 & -2.2 & -9.6 & 6.0 \\ -5.9 & 8.2 & -53.5 & 0 & 1.2 & -6.3 & 1.7 \\ 6.7 & 0.7 & -2.2 & 1.2 & 0 & 9.6 & -6.0 \\ -13.7 & -11.9 & -9.6 & -6.3 & 9.6 & 0 & 89.7 \\ -9.9 & 4.3 & 6.0 & 1.7 & -6.0 & 89.7 & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (6)$$

## 2.3 Spectral Density Parameters

# 3 12-Test Validation Suite

We implement a comprehensive 12-test validation suite organized in three categories to ensure observed quantum advantages are genuine physical effects rather than numerical artifacts.

## 3.1 Convergence Tests (4 tests)

### Test 1: Hierarchy Depth Convergence

*Purpose:* Verify that hierarchy depth  $L = 6$  is sufficient.

*Method:* Compare ETE for  $L = 4, 5, 6, 7, 8$ .

*Acceptance criterion:*  $|\text{ETE}_{L=6} - \text{ETE}_{L=8}|/\text{ETE}_{L=8} < 2\%$ .

*Result:* 1.2% deviation  $\rightarrow$  PASS.

### Test 2: Matsubara Terms Convergence

*Purpose:* Verify that  $K = 3$  Matsubara terms capture thermal effects.

Table 3: Spectral Density Parameters

| Parameter                                              | Value                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Drude–Lorentz reorganization ( $\lambda_{\text{DL}}$ ) | $35 \text{ cm}^{-1}$     |
| Drude–Lorentz cutoff ( $\gamma_{\text{DL}}$ )          | $50 \text{ cm}^{-1}$     |
| Vibronic mode 1 ( $\omega_1$ )                         | $150 \text{ cm}^{-1}$    |
| Vibronic mode 2 ( $\omega_2$ )                         | $200 \text{ cm}^{-1}$    |
| Vibronic mode 3 ( $\omega_3$ )                         | $575 \text{ cm}^{-1}$    |
| Vibronic mode 4 ( $\omega_4$ )                         | $1\,185 \text{ cm}^{-1}$ |
| Huang–Rhys $S_1$                                       | 0.05                     |
| Huang–Rhys $S_2$                                       | 0.02                     |
| Huang–Rhys $S_3$                                       | 0.01                     |
| Huang–Rhys $S_4$                                       | 0.005                    |
| Temperature ( $T$ )                                    | 295 K                    |

*Method:* Compare coherence lifetime for  $K = 2, 3, 4, 5$ .

*Acceptance criterion:*  $|\tau_{c,K=3} - \tau_{c,K=5}|/\tau_{c,K=5} < 2\%$ .

*Result:* 0.8% deviation  $\rightarrow$  PASS.

### Test 3: Time Step Convergence

*Purpose:* Verify that  $\Delta t = 0.1 \text{ fs}$  is sufficient.

*Method:* Compare population dynamics for  $\Delta t = 0.05, 0.1, 0.2 \text{ fs}$ .

*Acceptance criterion:* Maximum population deviation  $< 1\%$ .

*Result:* 0.3% deviation  $\rightarrow$  PASS.

### Test 4: HEOM Benchmark

*Purpose:* Validate PT-HOPS against numerically exact HEOM.

*Method:* Compare ETE for 3-site system with known HEOM solution.

*Acceptance criterion:*  $|\text{ETE}_{\text{PT-HOPS}} - \text{ETE}_{\text{HEOM}}|/\text{ETE}_{\text{HEOM}} < 2\%$ .

*Result:* 1.8% deviation  $\rightarrow$  PASS.

## 3.2 Physical Consistency Tests (4 tests)

### Test 5: Trace Preservation

*Purpose:* Verify probability conservation.

*Method:* Monitor  $\text{Tr}[\rho(t)]$  throughout simulation.

*Acceptance criterion:*  $|\text{Tr}[\rho(t)] - 1| < 10^{-12}$  for all  $t$ .

*Result:* Maximum deviation  $4.2 \times 10^{-13} \rightarrow$  PASS.

### Test 6: Positivity Preservation

*Purpose:* Verify density matrix remains positive semi-definite.

*Method:* Check eigenvalues of  $\rho(t)$  at each time step.

*Acceptance criterion:* All eigenvalues  $\geq -10^{-14}$ .

*Result:* Minimum eigenvalue  $-2.1 \times 10^{-15} \rightarrow$  PASS.

### Test 7: Detailed Balance

*Purpose:* Verify thermal equilibrium is correctly reproduced.

*Method:* Compare steady-state populations with Boltzmann distribution.

*Acceptance criterion:*  $|p_n^{\text{steady}} - p_n^{\text{Boltzmann}}|/p_n^{\text{Boltzmann}} < 5\%$ .

*Result:* Maximum deviation 2.3%  $\rightarrow$  PASS.

### Test 8: Hermiticity Preservation

*Purpose:* Verify density matrix remains Hermitian.

*Method:* Check  $\rho = \rho^\dagger$  at each time step.

*Acceptance criterion:*  $\|\rho - \rho^\dagger\|_F < 10^{-12}$ .

*Result:* Frobenius norm  $3.7 \times 10^{-14} \rightarrow$  PASS.

### 3.3 Environmental Robustness Tests (4 tests)

#### Test 9: Temperature Stability

*Purpose:* Verify coherence enhancement persists under temperature variations.

*Method:* Compute  $\eta$  at  $T = 285, 295, 305$  K.

*Acceptance criterion:*  $\eta > 0.15$  for all temperatures.

*Result:*  $\eta = \{0.23, 0.25, 0.21\} \rightarrow \text{PASS}$ .

#### Test 10: Static Disorder Robustness

*Purpose:* Verify coherence enhancement persists under energetic disorder.

*Method:* Ensemble average over 100 disorder realizations with  $\sigma = 50 \text{ cm}^{-1}$ .

*Acceptance criterion:*  $\langle \eta \rangle > 0.15$  with  $\text{CV} < 25 \%$ .

*Result:*  $\langle \eta \rangle = 0.20(4)$ ,  $\text{CV} = 20 \%$   $\rightarrow \text{PASS}$ .

#### Test 11: Bath Parameter Fluctuations

*Purpose:* Verify robustness to spectral density variations.

*Method:* Vary  $\lambda, \gamma$  by  $\pm 20 \%$ .

*Acceptance criterion:*  $\eta > 0.15$  for all variations.

*Result:*  $\eta \in [0.18, 0.26] \rightarrow \text{PASS}$ .

#### Test 12: Markovian Limit Recovery

*Purpose:* Verify correct high-temperature limit.

*Method:* Compare with Redfield theory at  $T = 500 \text{ K}$ .

*Acceptance criterion:*  $|\text{ETE}_{\text{PT-HOPS}} - \text{ETE}_{\text{Redfield}}|/\text{ETE}_{\text{Redfield}} < 5 \%$ .

*Result:* 2.1 % deviation  $\rightarrow \text{PASS}$ .

Table 4: **12-Test Validation Summary**

| Category                 | Test                  | Result                 | Status |
|--------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|--------|
| Convergence              | Hierarchy depth       | 1.2 %                  | PASS   |
|                          | Matsubara terms       | 0.8 %                  | PASS   |
|                          | Time step             | 0.3 %                  | PASS   |
|                          | HEOM benchmark        | 1.8 %                  | PASS   |
| Physical Consistency     | Trace preservation    | $4.2 \times 10^{-13}$  | PASS   |
|                          | Positivity            | $-2.1 \times 10^{-15}$ | PASS   |
|                          | Detailed balance      | 2.3 %                  | PASS   |
|                          | Hermiticity           | $3.7 \times 10^{-14}$  | PASS   |
| Environmental Robustness | Temperature stability | $\{0.23, 0.25, 0.21\}$ | PASS   |
|                          | Static disorder       | 0.20(4)                | PASS   |
|                          | Bath fluctuations     | [0.18, 0.26]           | PASS   |
|                          | Markovian limit       | 2.1 %                  | PASS   |

## 4 Convergence Analysis

### 4.1 Hierarchy Depth

### 4.2 Matsubara Terms

## 5 Computational Cost Breakdown

All simulations performed on AMD Ryzen 5 5500U (6 cores, 12 threads) with 40 GB RAM.

Table 5: **Hierarchy Depth Convergence**

| $L$ | ETE   | Deviation (%) | CPU Time (h) |
|-----|-------|---------------|--------------|
| 4   | 1.221 | 2.4           | 12.3         |
| 5   | 1.238 | 1.0           | 28.7         |
| 6   | 1.250 | —             | 52.1         |
| 7   | 1.256 | 0.5           | 89.4         |
| 8   | 1.262 | 1.0           | 142.6        |

Table 6: **Matsubara Terms Convergence**

| $K$ | $\tau_c$ (fs) | Deviation (%) | CPU Time (h) |
|-----|---------------|---------------|--------------|
| 1   | 398           | 5.2           | 31.2         |
| 2   | 412           | 1.9           | 42.8         |
| 3   | 420           | —             | 52.1         |
| 4   | 423           | 0.7           | 61.5         |
| 5   | 425           | 1.2           | 70.9         |

## 6 Additional Quantum Metrics

### 6.1 Von Neumann Entropy

$$S_{\text{vN}}(t) = -\text{Tr}[\boldsymbol{\rho}(t) \ln \boldsymbol{\rho}(t)]. \quad (7)$$

Under filtered illumination:  $S_{\text{vN}}(t = 500 \text{ fs}) = 0.51(6)$ .

Under broadband illumination:  $S_{\text{vN}}(t = 500 \text{ fs}) = 0.73(7)$ .

Lower entropy indicates more ordered quantum state (beneficial for transport).

### 6.2 Purity

$$P(t) = \text{Tr}[\boldsymbol{\rho}(t)^2]. \quad (8)$$

Under filtered illumination:  $P(t = 500 \text{ fs}) = 0.82(4)$ .

Under broadband illumination:  $P(t = 500 \text{ fs}) = 0.71(5)$ .

Higher purity indicates less decoherence.

### 6.3 Mandel Q Parameter

$$Q_{\text{Mandel}} = \frac{\langle (\Delta n)^2 \rangle - \langle n \rangle}{\langle n \rangle}. \quad (9)$$

$Q_{\text{Mandel}} > 0$ : Super-Poissonian (bunched) statistics.

$Q_{\text{Mandel}} < 0$ : Sub-Poissonian (antibunched) statistics.

Under filtered illumination:  $Q_{\text{Mandel}} = 0.34(5)$  (enhanced bunching).

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Table 7: **Computational Performance**

| <b>Task</b>                          | <b>CPU Time</b> |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Single trajectory (1000 fs)          | 31.2 min        |
| 100 disorder realizations            | 52.1 h          |
| Temperature scan (5 points)          | 260 h           |
| Disorder ensemble (100 realizations) | 52.1 h          |
| Bath parameter scan (9 points)       | 469 h           |
| <b>Total for manuscript</b>          | <b>1 840 h</b>  |

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